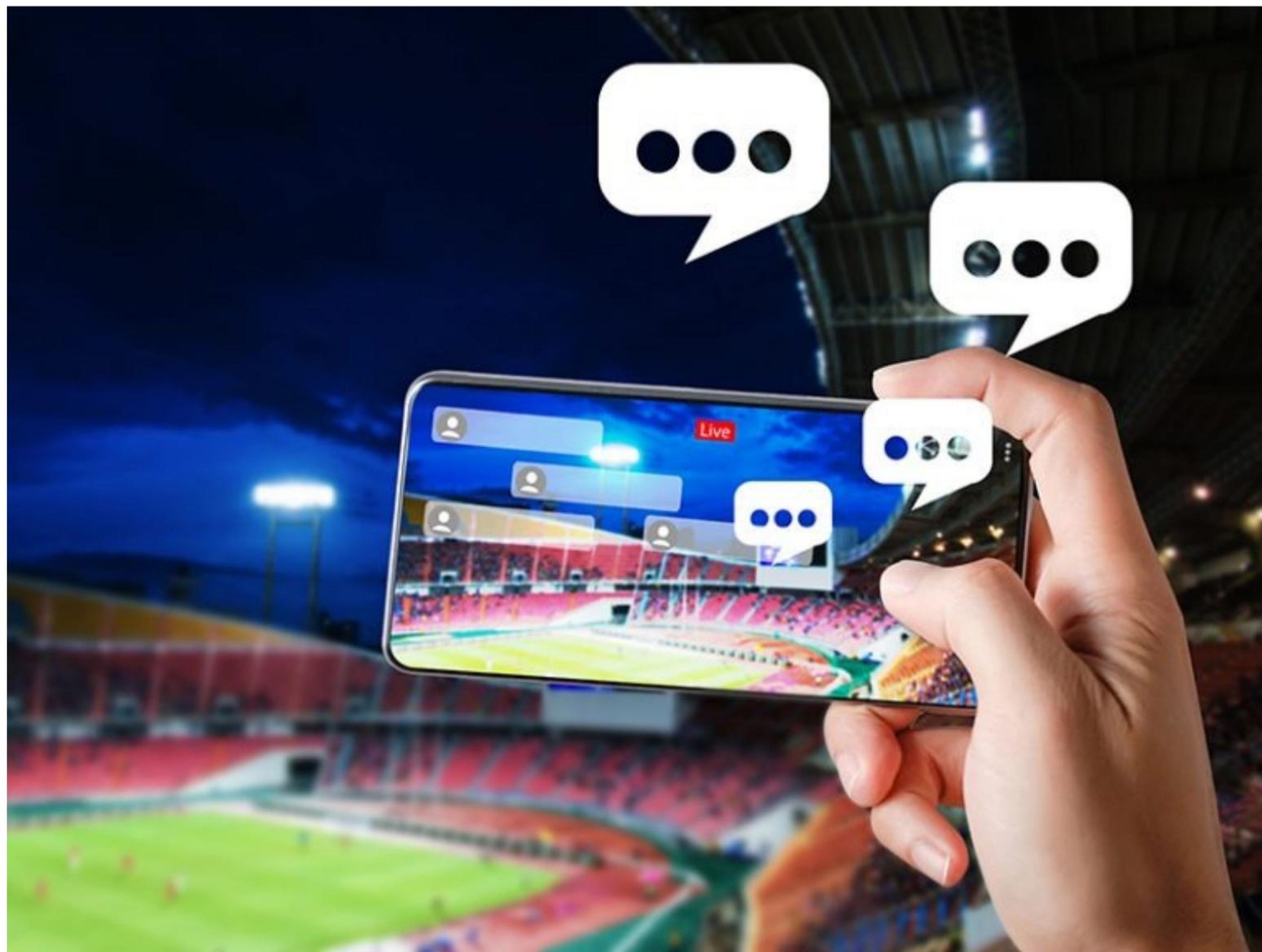




Sports and Social Media I

SPM381 Consumer Behavior in Sport

What is social media to you?

How did social media change your life?

The False Self on Social Media

Watch Video Clips (below)

What's on your mind?

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QxVZYiJKl1Y>

**Social Media Friendship-
Real vs. Virtual ??**

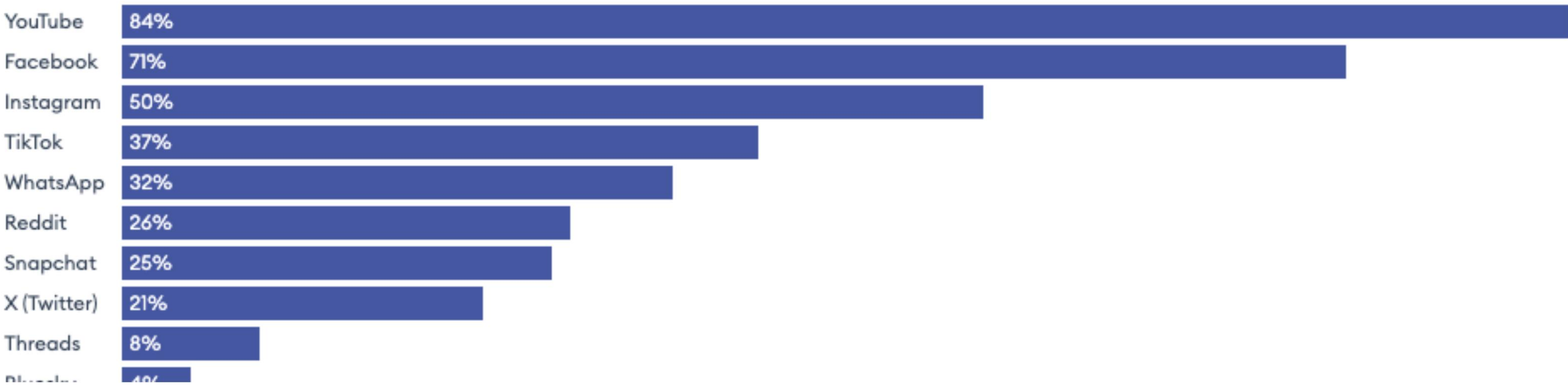




Social Media Quick Facts

- **5.79 billion people** now use social media worldwide, more than two-thirds of everyone on Earth
- **Meta's daily active people** across Facebook, Instagram, Messenger and WhatsApp hit 3.56 billion in Q1 2026
- **Meta's advertising-driven revenue** hit \$56.31 billion in Q1 2026, up 33% year-over-year
- **Brand awareness** is now the #1 goal for 59% of social media marketers, more than double the 29% who ranked it first in 2025
- Social media in 2026 is less about driving immediate sales than influencing the decisions that happen afterward. People increasingly discover brands, products and creators on social platforms before researching, comparing and purchasing elsewhere

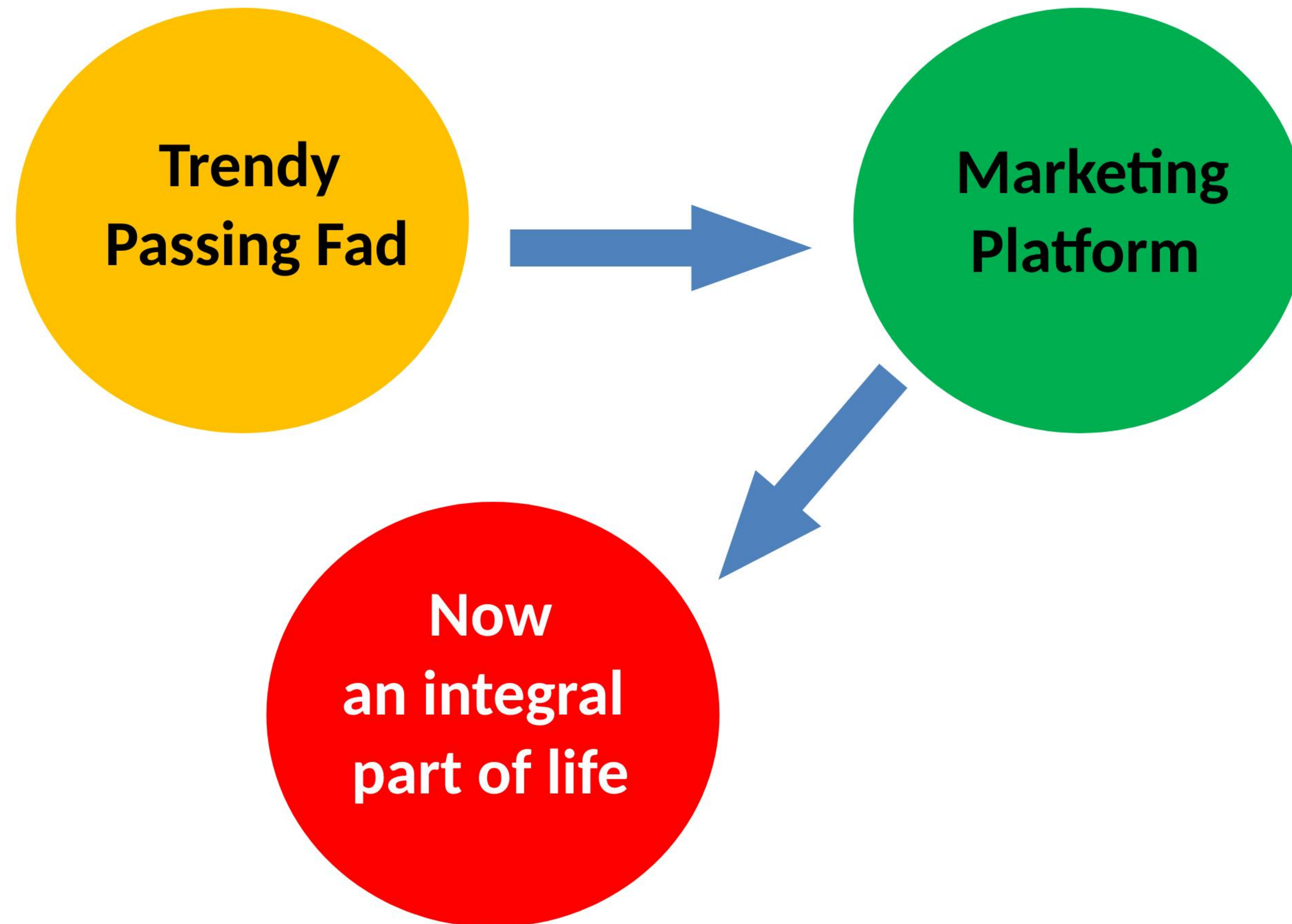
Top Social Media Platforms in 2026



Social Media Quick Facts cont.

- More than 8 million advertisers now use at least one of Meta’s AI ad creative tools, with especially strong adoption among small and medium-sized businesses
- Reddit’s daily active user base grew 17% year-over-year to 126.8 million in Q1 2026
- 84% of shoppers say they feel more confident in their purchase decisions after researching on Reddit
- LinkedIn may have lower overall marketer adoption than Instagram or Facebook, but it remains the most-used B2B platform

Perception of Social Media

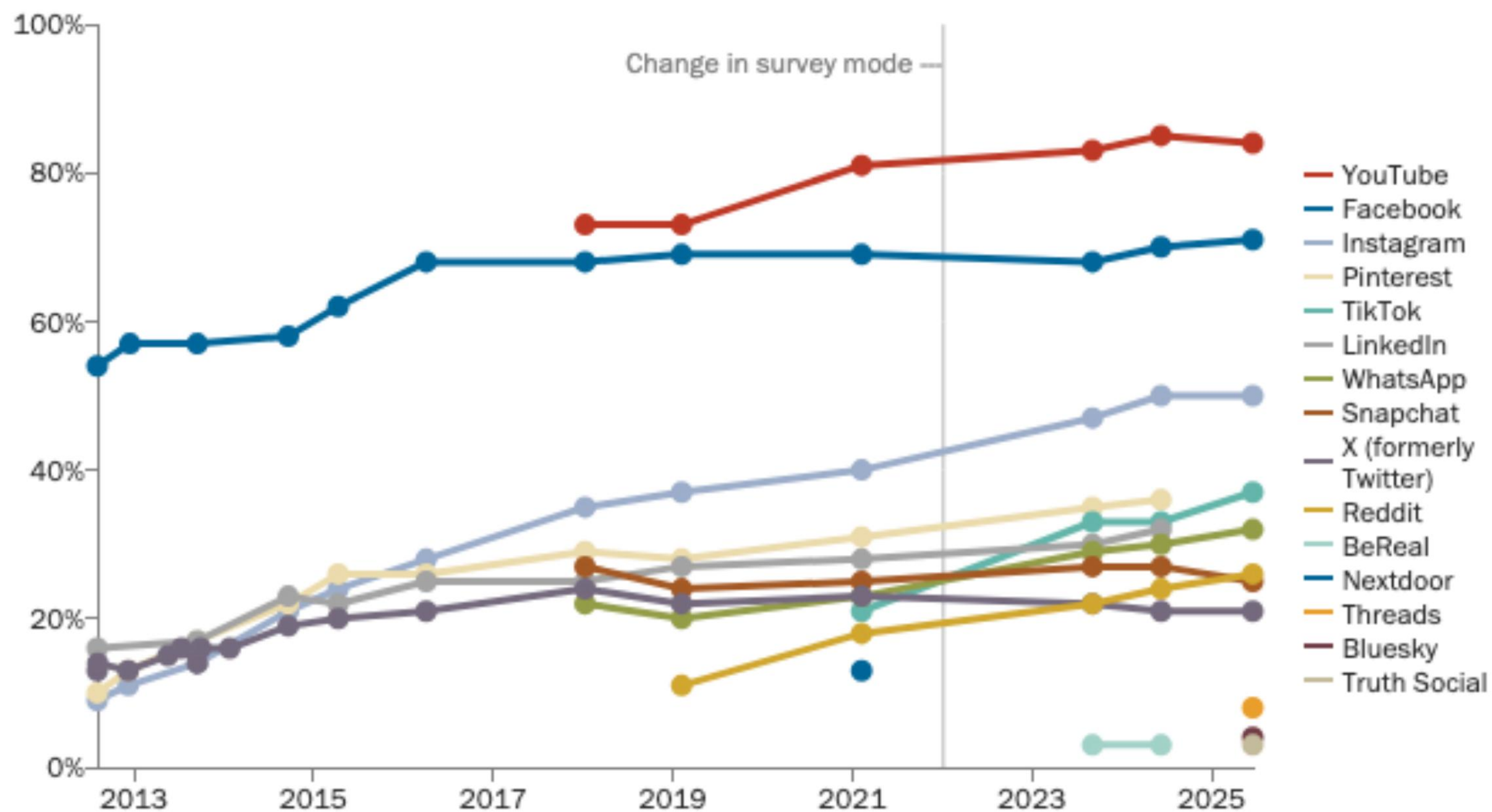


VINTAGE SOCIAL MEDIA



Which social media platforms are most popular

% of U.S. adults who say they ever use ...

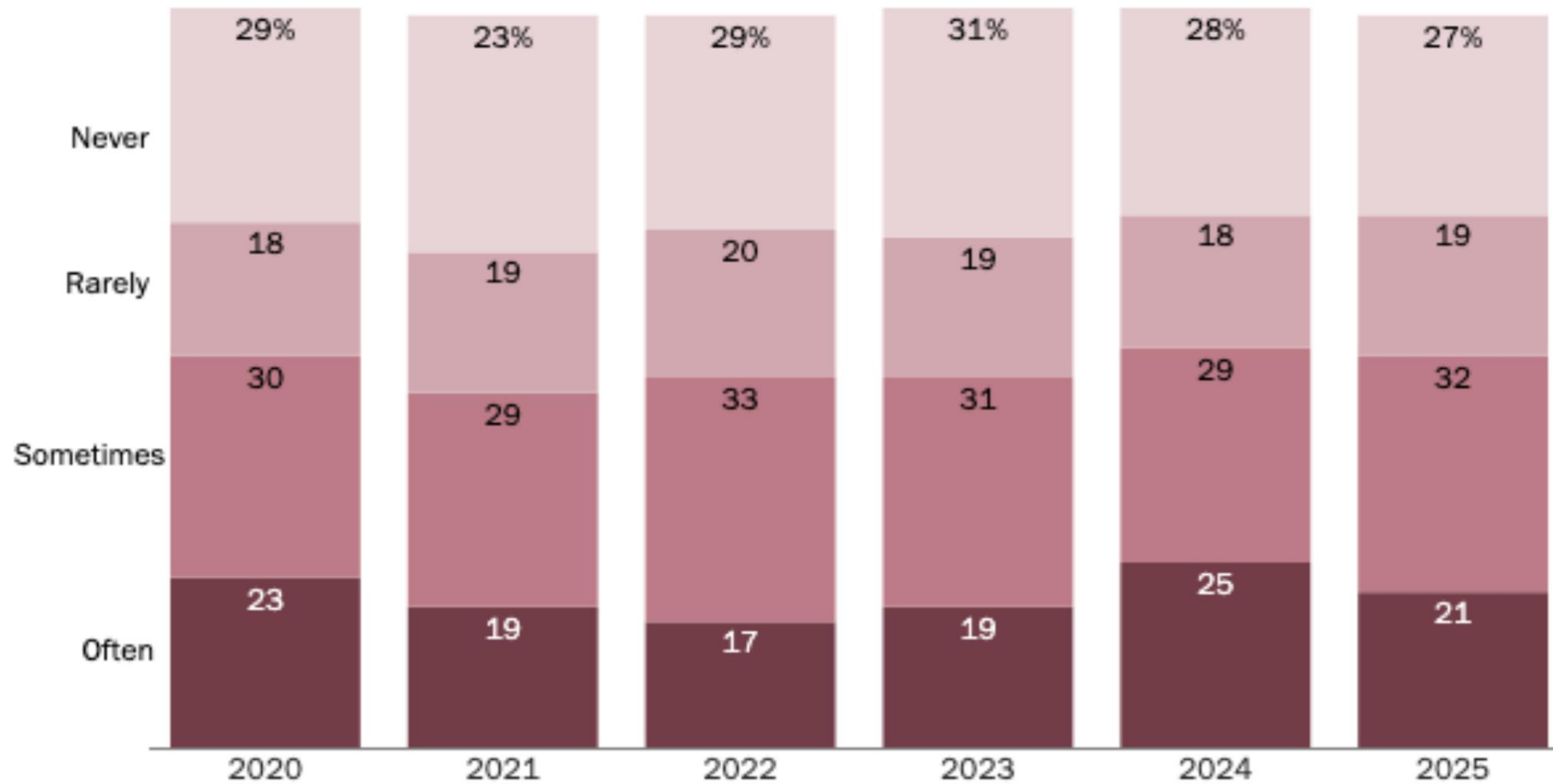


How does each social media platform perform?

AGE	GENDER	RACE &	HOUSEHOLD	EDUCATION	COMMUNITY
		ETHNICITY	INCOME		
Ages 18-29		30-49	50-64	65+	
YouTube	95	92	85	64	
Facebook	68	80	74	57	
Instagram	80	62	40	19	
TikTok	63	44	30	12	
WhatsApp	37	40	30	20	
Reddit	48	35	16	6	
Snapchat	58	31	13	4	
X (formerly Twitter)	33	25	16	10	
Threads	15	10	6	3	
Bluesky	6	5	3	2	
Truth Social	1	3	5	4	

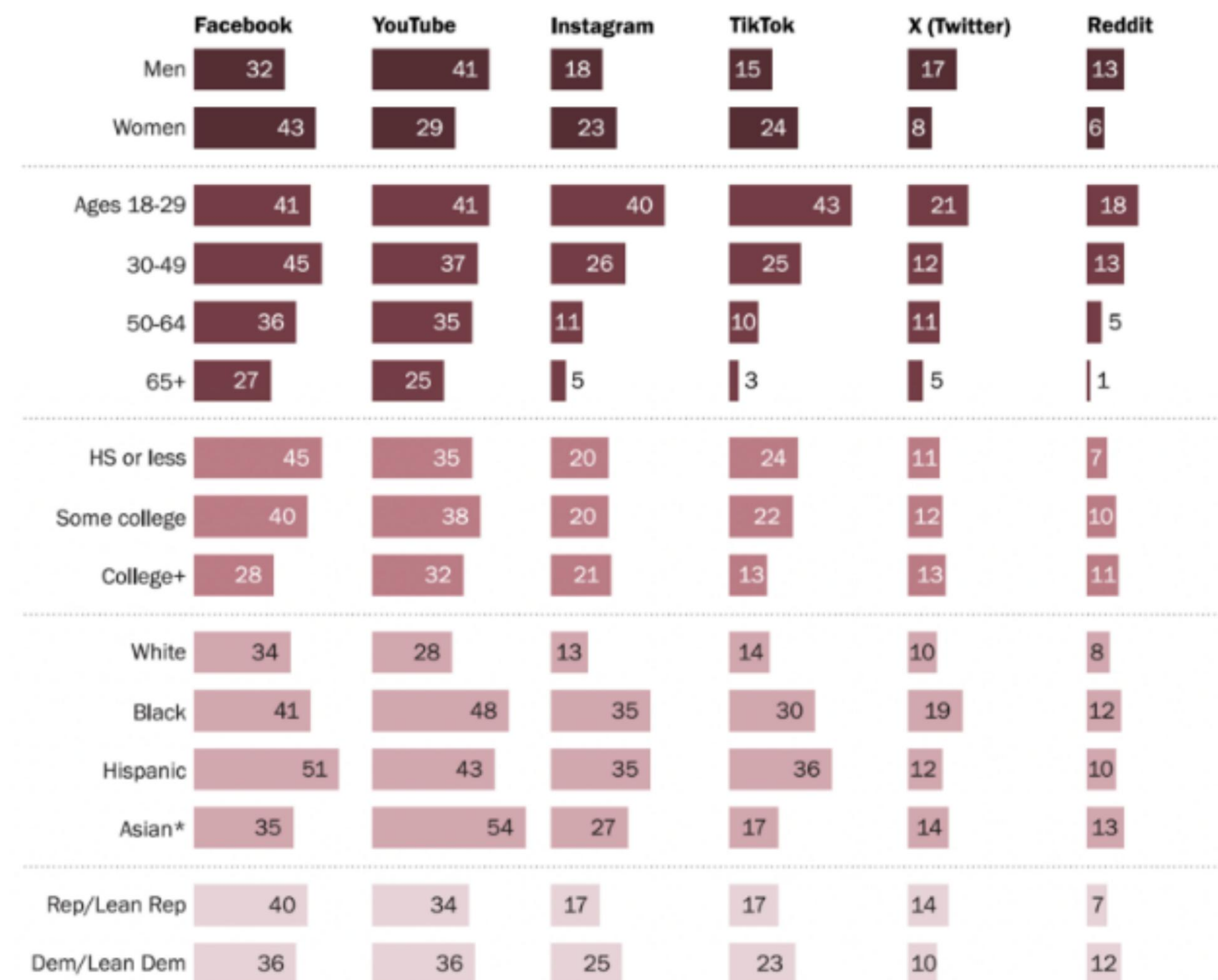
News consumption on social media

% of U.S. adults who say they get news from social media ...



Demographics and party identification of regular social media news consumers in the U.S.

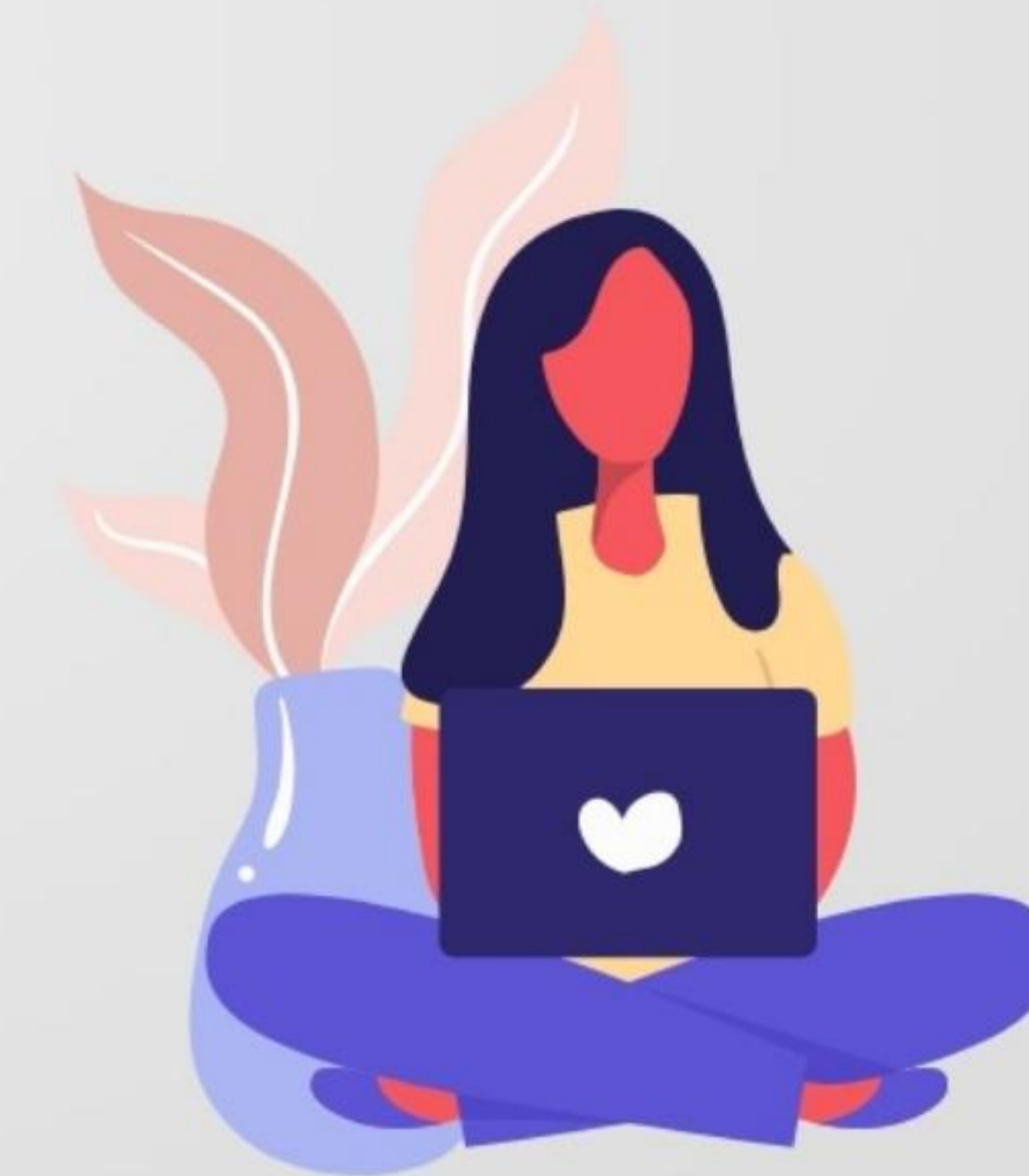
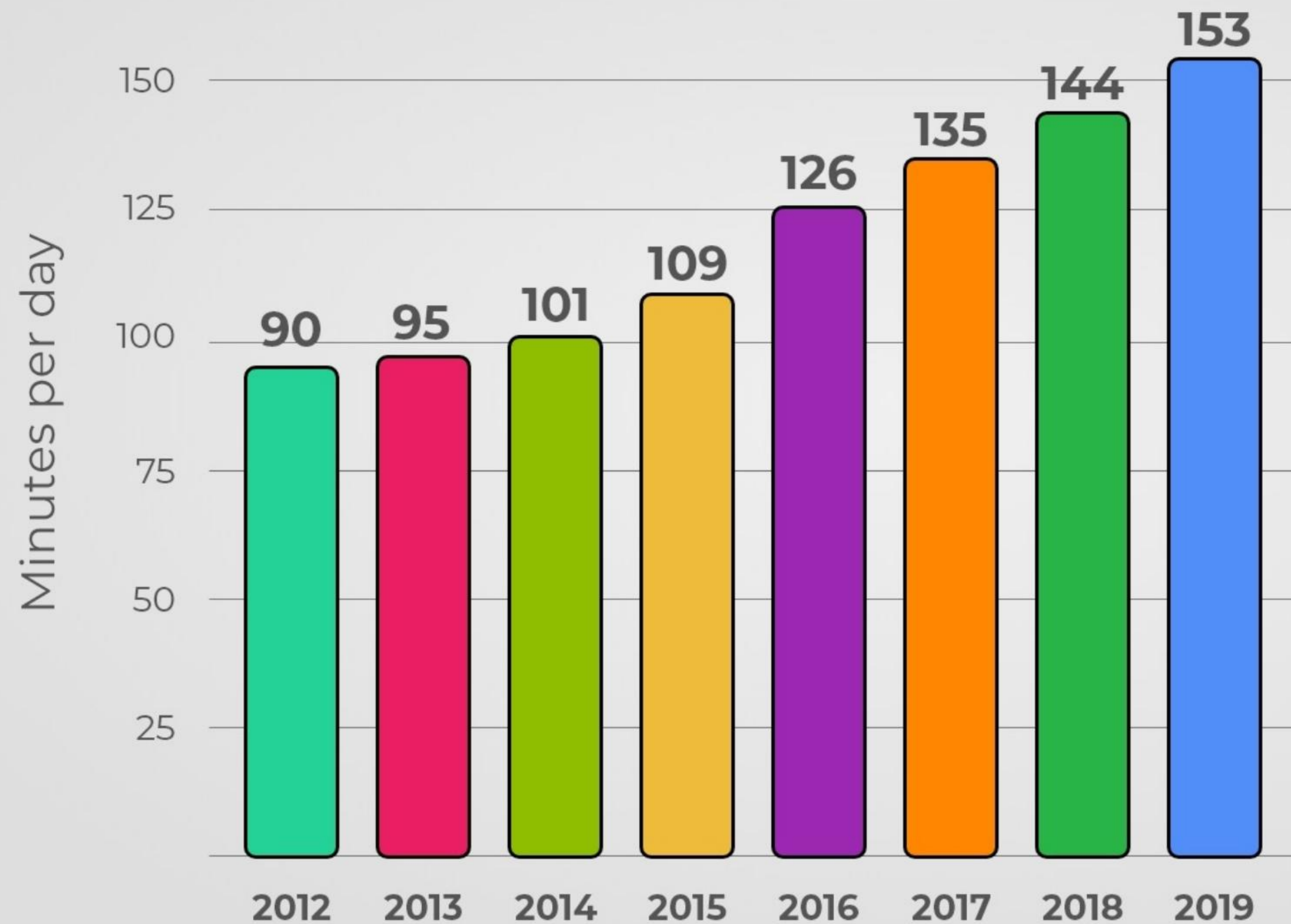
% of U.S. adults who say they *regularly* get news from each social media site



The Growing Impact of Social Media

Daily Time Spent On Social Networking

2012-2019 (in minutes)



The Growing Impact of Social Media cont.

Average Time Spent In a Lifetime



1 Years, 8 Months
Doing Housework



1 Years, 11 Months
Socializing



2 Years, 2 Months
Shopping



3 Years, 7 Months
Eating & Drinking



6 Years, 8 Months
Using Social Media

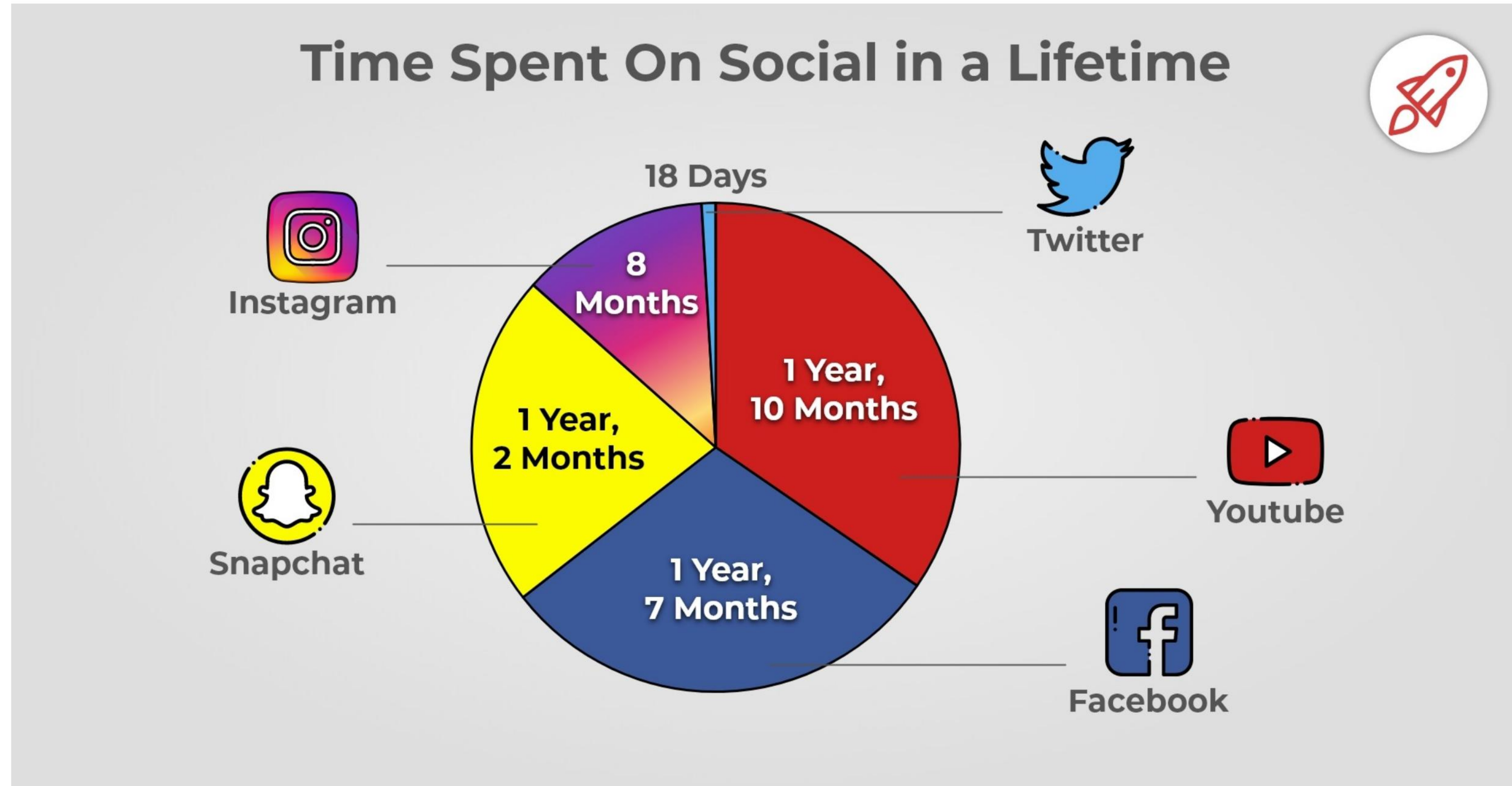


8 Years, 4 Months
Watching TV

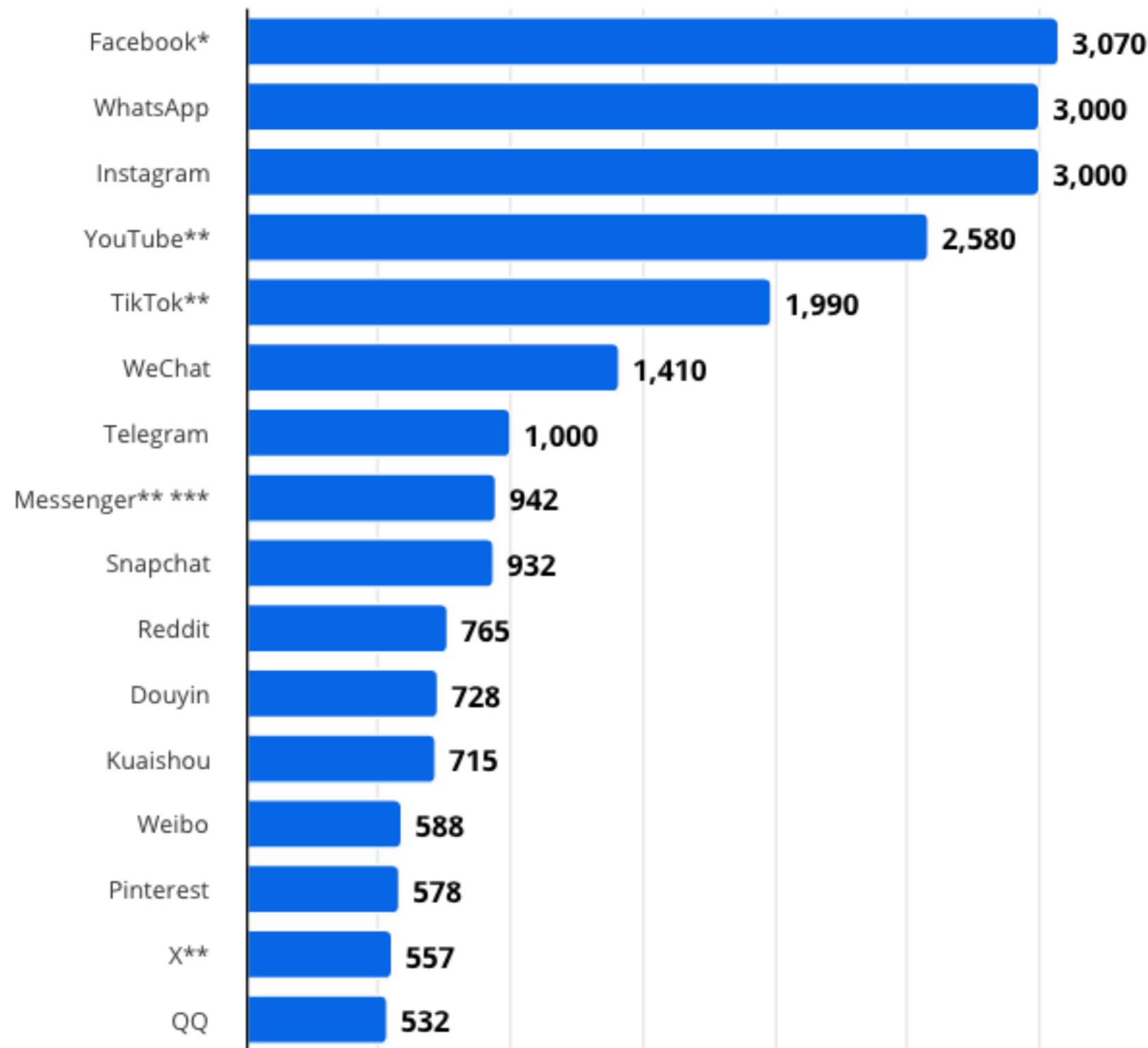


26 Years, 5 Months
Sleeping

The Growing Impact of Social Media cont.



Most popular social networks worldwide as of Oct 2025, ranked by number of active users

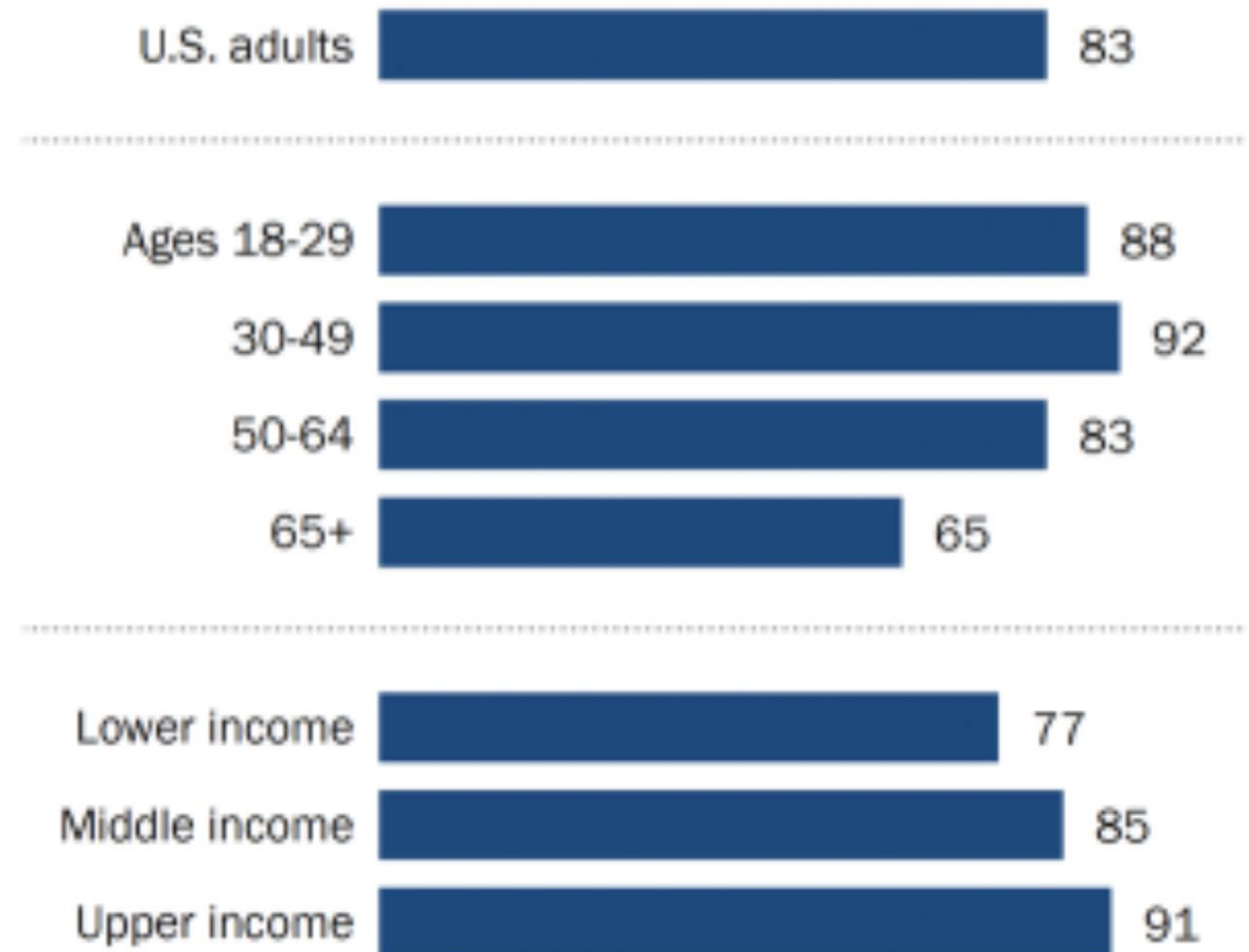


Number of active users in millions



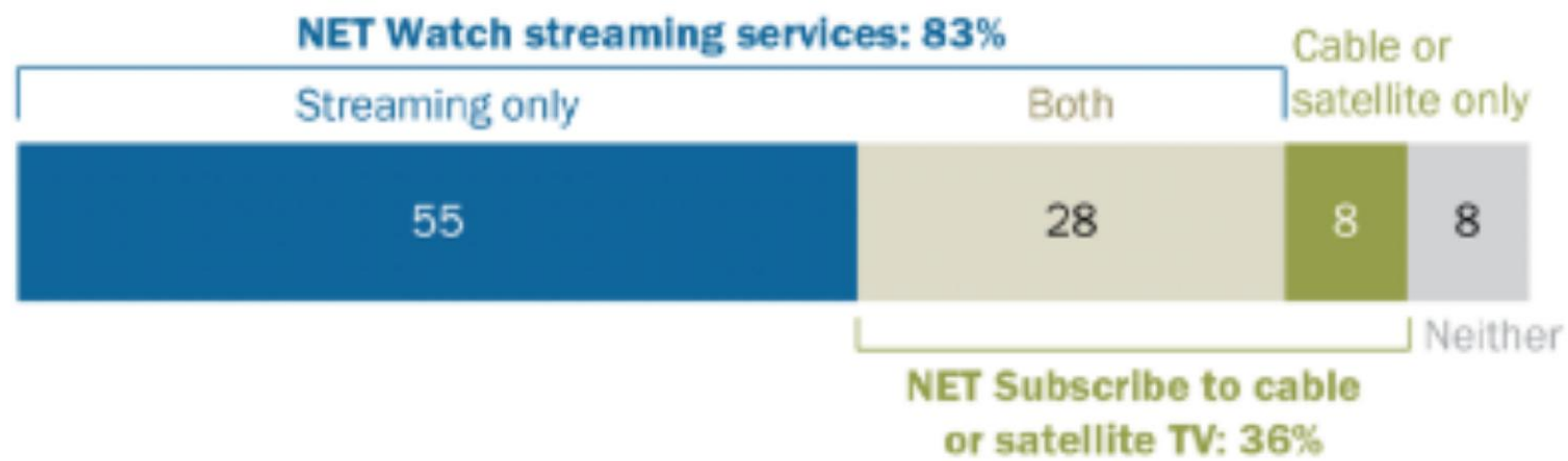
Most Americans use streaming services, including majorities across age and income groups

% of U.S. adults who say they ever watch programming on streaming services, such as Netflix, Disney+ or Amazon Prime Video



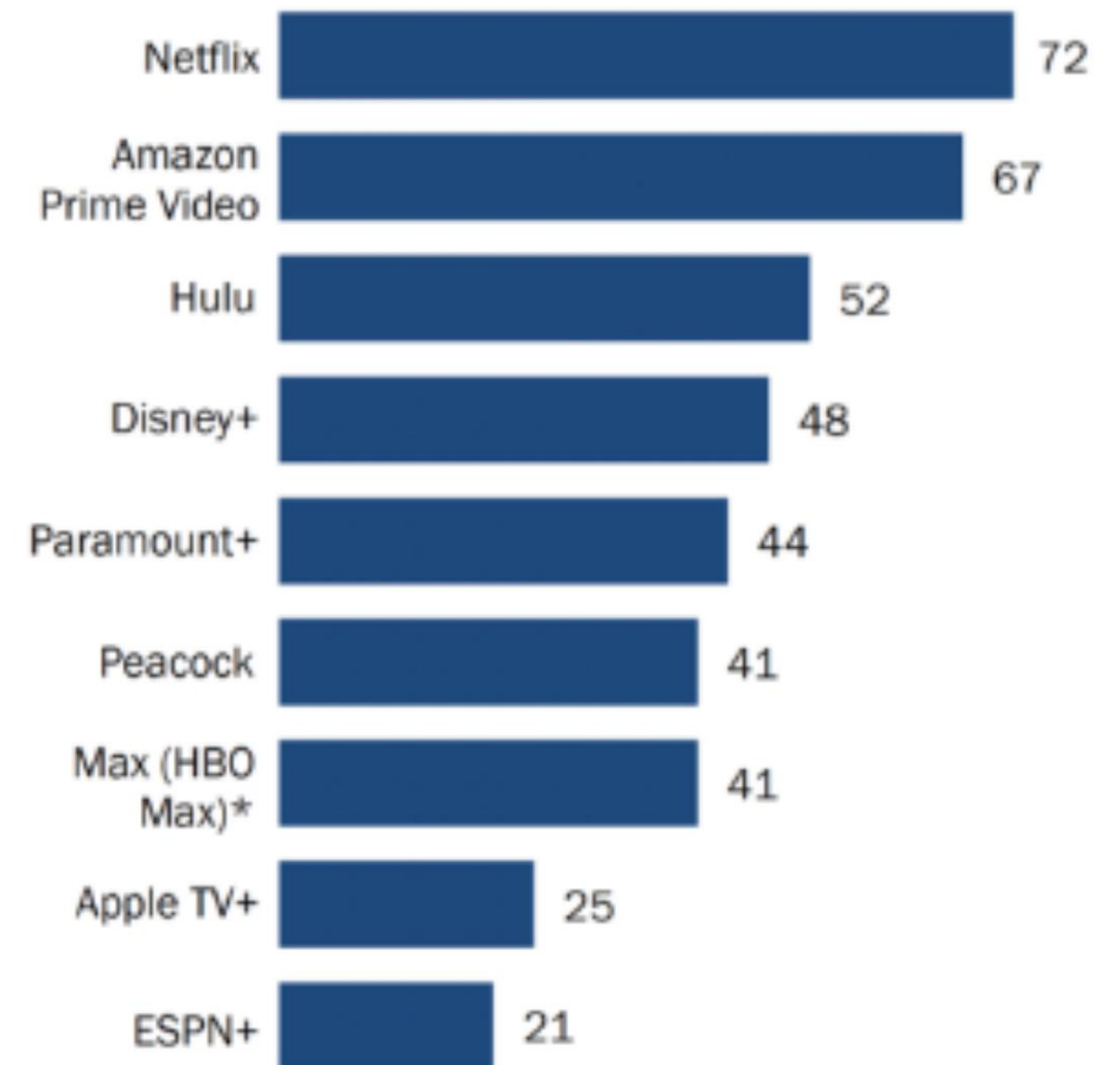
Just over half of Americans watch streaming services but do not subscribe to cable or satellite TV

% of U.S. adults who say they ...



Majorities of Americans watch Netflix, Amazon Prime Video

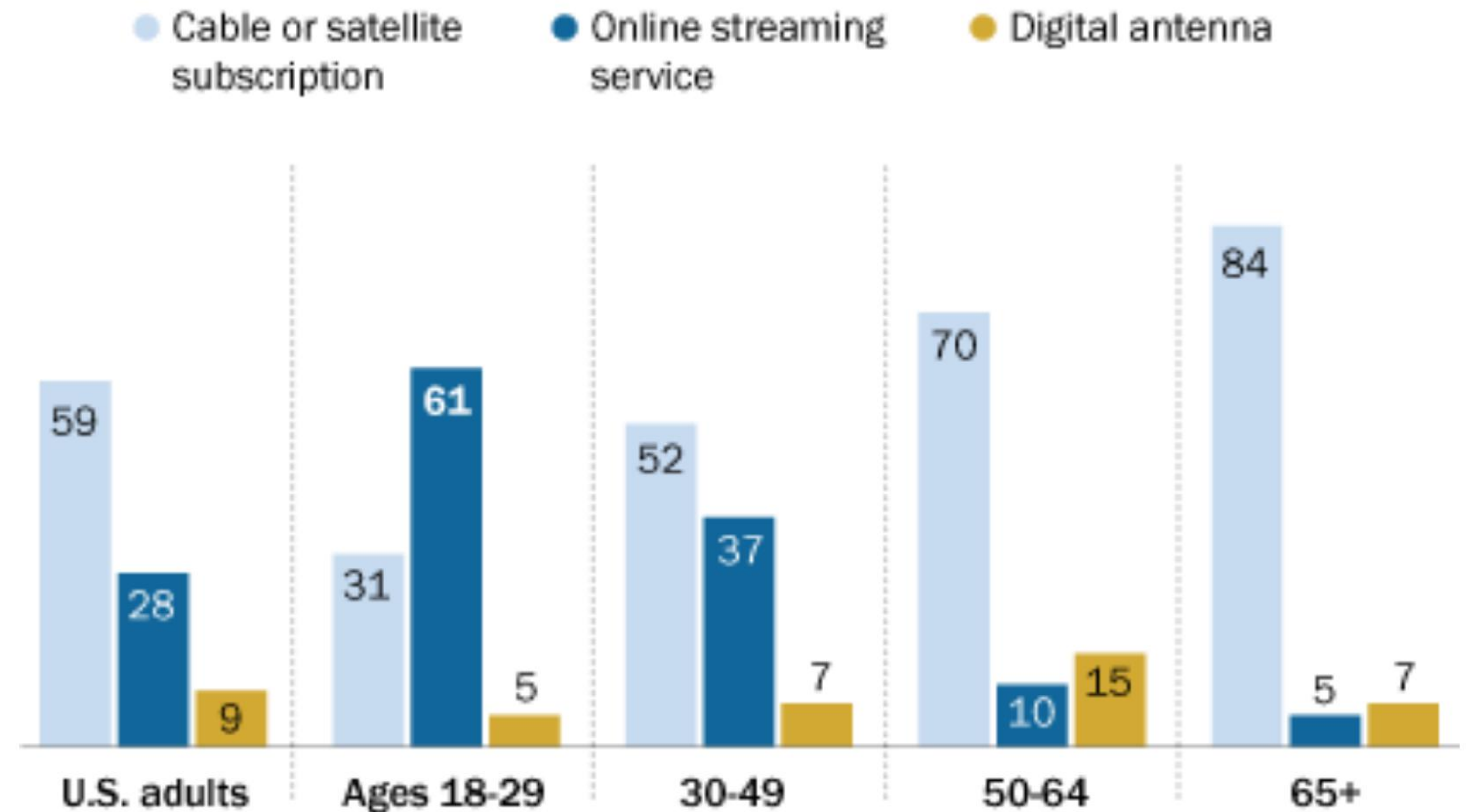
% of U.S. adults who say they ever watch programming on ...



About 6 in 10 young adults in U.S. primarily use online streaming to watch TV

Young adults use streaming services most to watch TV

% of U.S. adults who say ___ is the primary way they watch television



Source: Survey conducted Aug. 15-21, 2017.

PEW RESEARCH CENTER

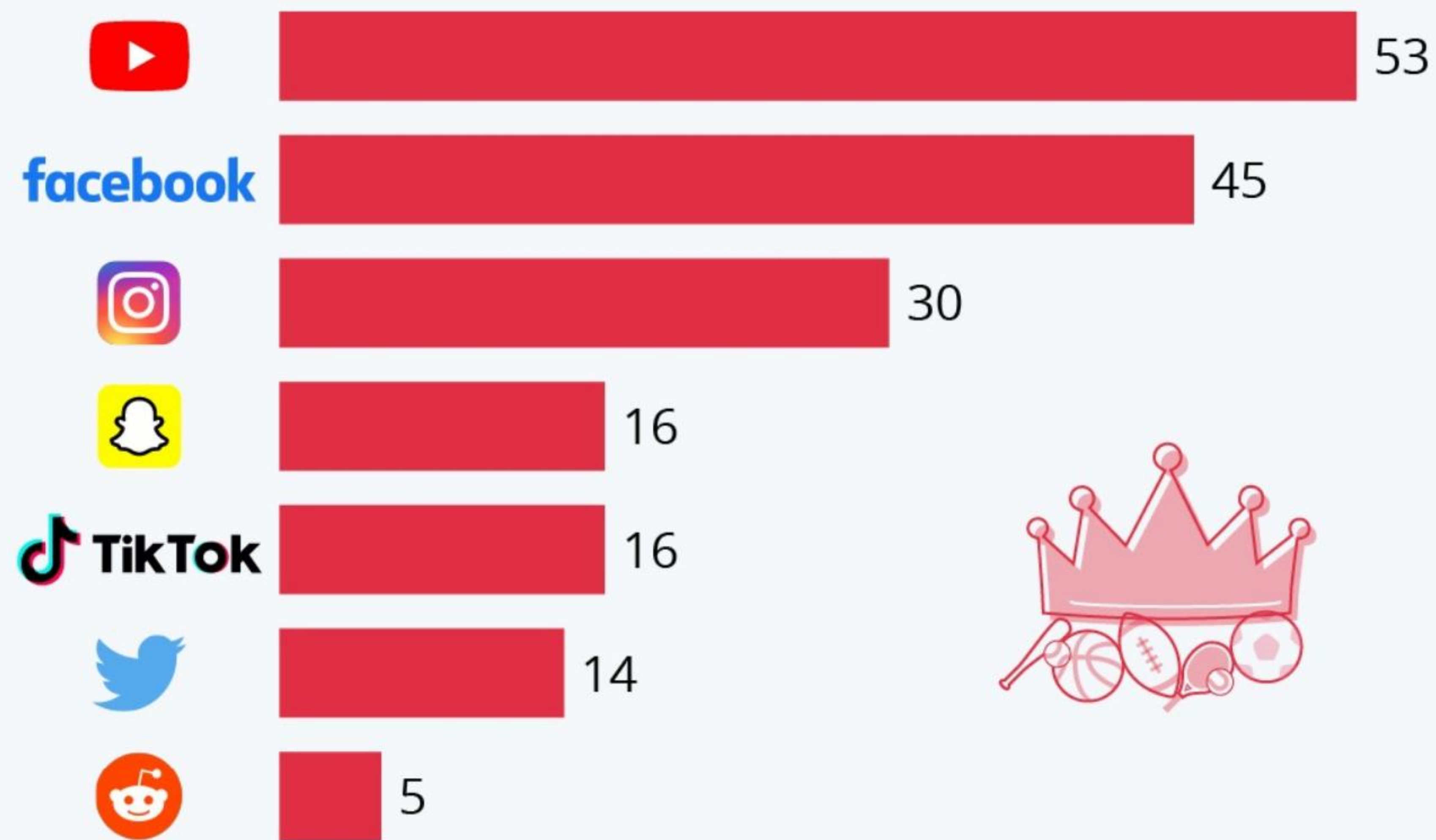
A person's hands are silhouetted against a bright, crowded stadium. The person is holding a smartphone horizontally, capturing a photo of the vast crowd. The stadium is filled with fans wearing orange, and the scene is illuminated by bright lights, likely from the event or the phone's flash. The text "How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media?" is overlaid in white, bold font across the center of the image.

How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media?

How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media cont.

YouTube is King of Sports Highlights

Percentage of Americans who view sports highlights on each of the following social media platforms



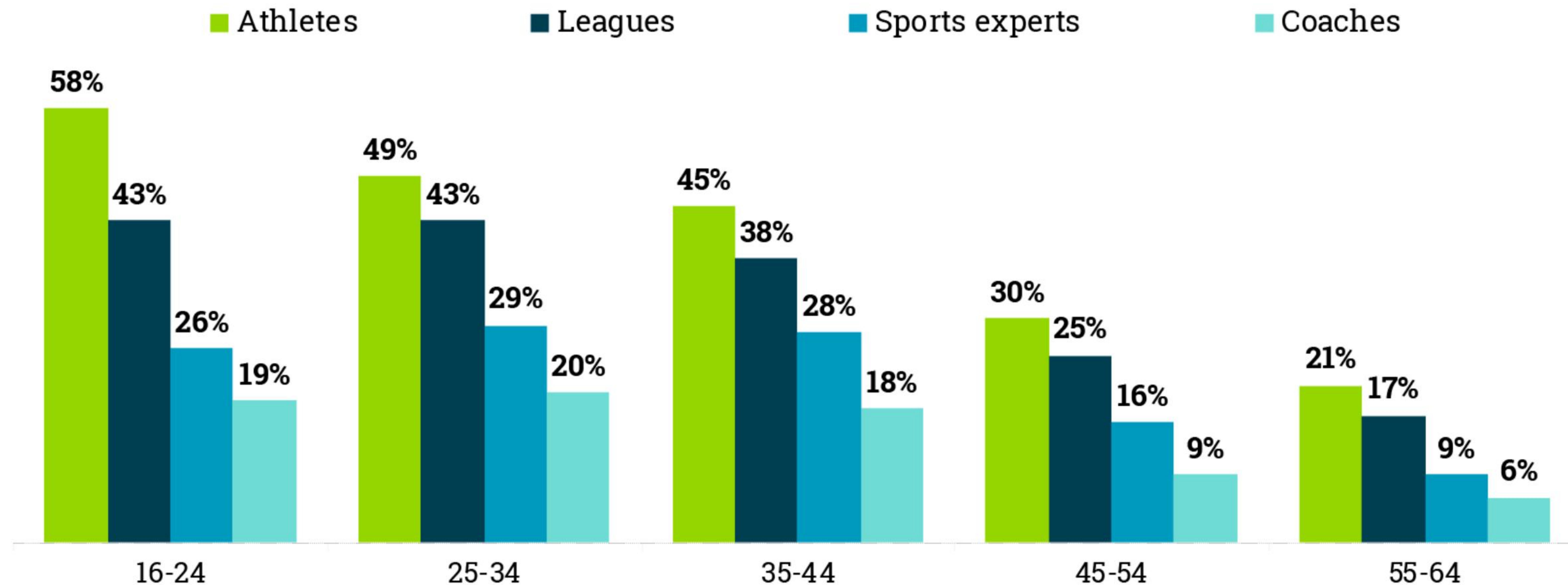
Survey conducted Sept. 2020 of 1,400 U.S. adults
Sources: Ring Digital, Survata



How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media cont.

Sports Fans' Social Media Engagement

% of sports fans in each age group who follow these accounts on social media



Published on MarketingCharts.com in June 2021 | Data Source: GWI

Based on a survey of 23,073 internet users ages 16-64 across 15 markets who are interested in sports or state that they watch, attend or participate in sports

**How did athletes and fans connect
before social media?**

Athletes



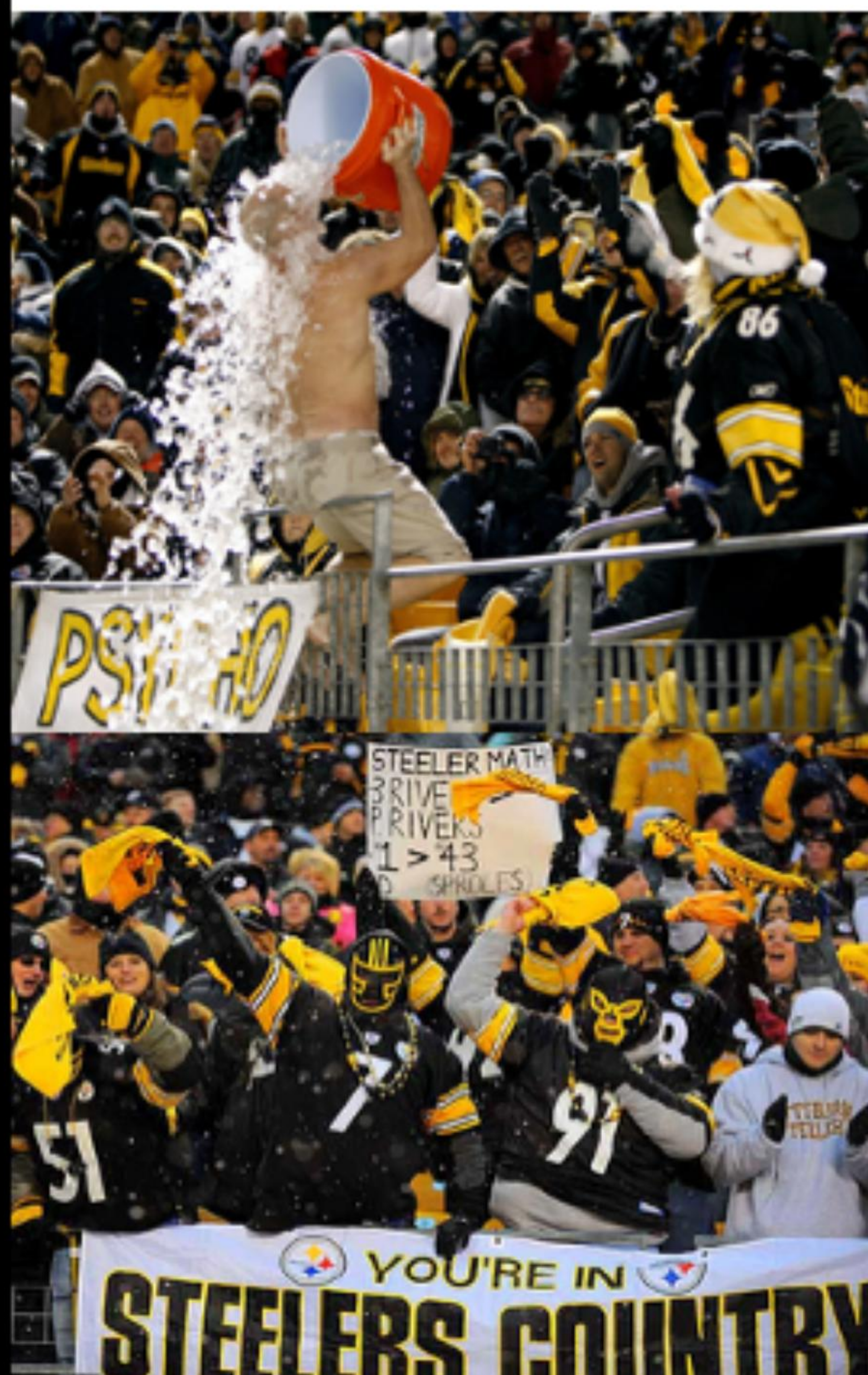
Press

**NBA, NFL, MLB,
NHL**

**Brands/
Advertisers**

Agent

Fans



Old days..

BOSTON
Herald.com **SPORTS**


Rollover For Coupon

SmartBakes
Streusel Cakes
Nutritious meets delicious

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[Red Sox & MLB](#) [Patriots & NFL](#) [Celtics & NBA](#) [Bruins & NHL](#) [College](#) [Columnists](#) [Revolution & Soccer](#) [Golf](#) [High School](#)

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Shaquille O'Neal returns to LA in colors of enemy

By Mark Murphy

Sunday, January 30, 2011 - Updated 5 minutes ago

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 E-mail  Print  (5) Comments   Text size  Share  Buzz up!

LOS ANGELES — Since the day he left and burned most of the remaining goodwill on his old Lakers team, Shaquille O'Neal has returned to the site of his greatest triumphs in an ever-changing look.

He's been a member of the Heat, Suns and Cavaliers. Today, he changes for the fourth time in his post-Lakers career, now as a Celtic. That image has to vex any Lakers fan who grew up like **Paul Pierce** [stats], living from one playoff series to the next between these two teams



Photo by AP file

TWO FOR THE AGES: Kobe Bryant and Shaquille O'Neal celebrate a Lakers victory during the 2001 season.







**The connection was controlled,
filtered, and temporal**

**How do athletes and fans connect now
using social media?**

Athletes



Social media is not
replacing traditional
media, but rather
balancing it! (Richard Ting)



Press

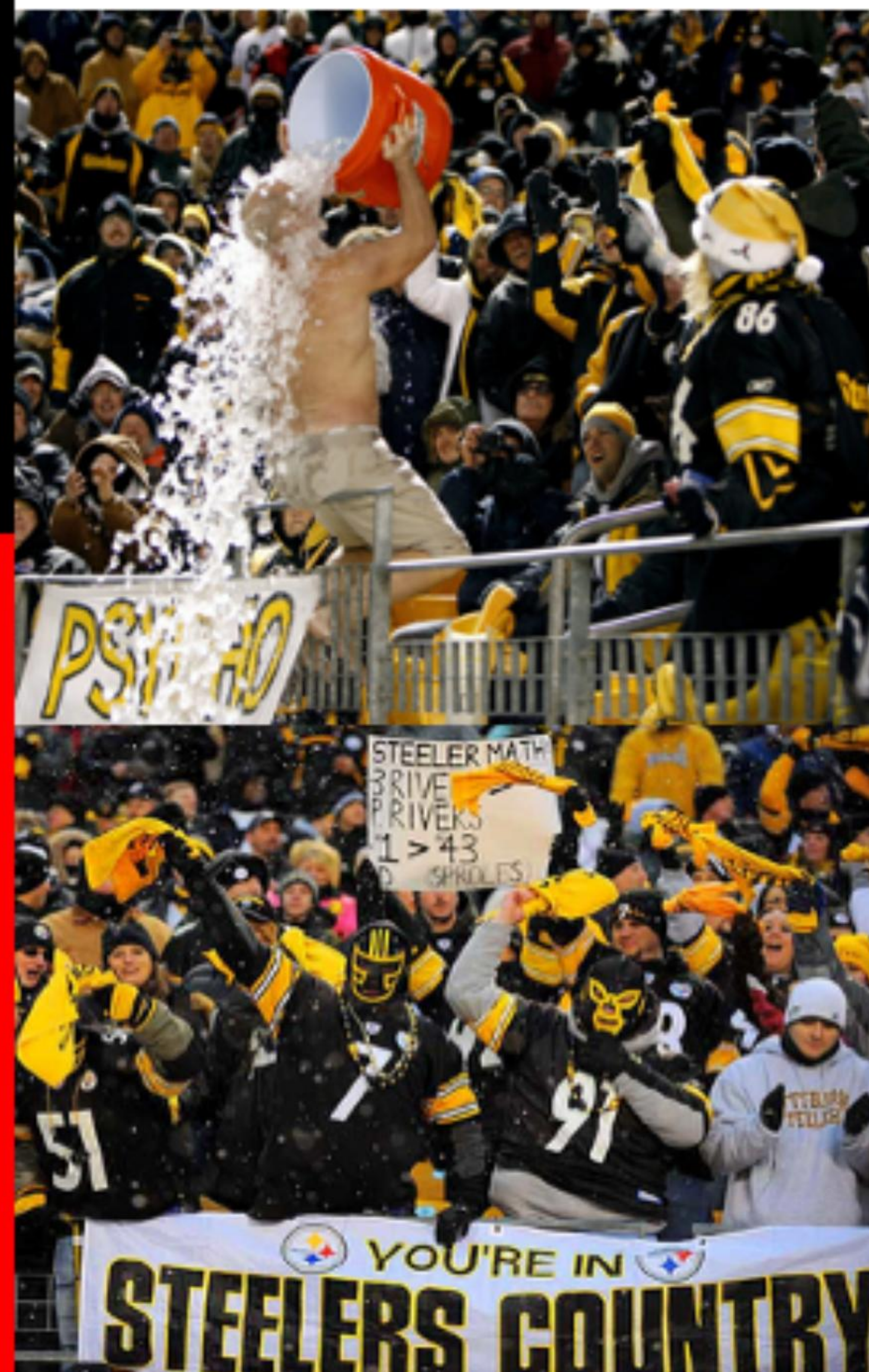
**NBA, NFL, MLB,
NHL**

**Brands/
Advertisers**

Agent

Social Media

Fans



The new relationship model is a **dialogue**



Not a **monologue**



A Review of Recent History

Web 1.0 to Web 2.0 in simple terms

Web 1.0: Mostly a one-way read/write, centralized experience (1997-2007)

- A brand, person, company etc. builds a website, populates with content.
- People visit that website to read the content but have limited ways to interact , dialogue and generate unique content to share with the site owner and other visitors.
- some interaction occurs through forums, message boards and email.
- In web 1.0, users would typically browse via **a singular device**, the PC.

What changed?

Web 1.0 to Web 2.0 in simple terms



A Review of Recent History cont.

Web 1.0 to Web 2.0 in simple terms

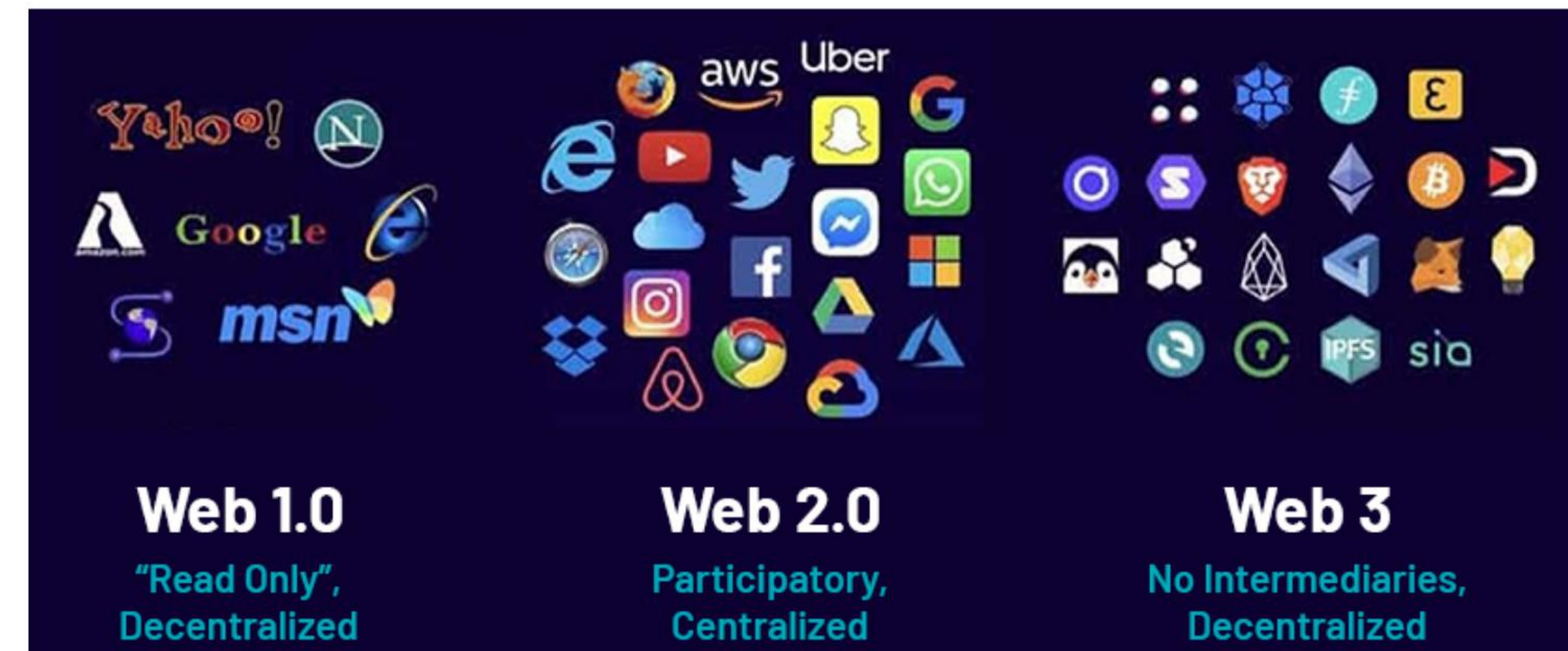
Web 2.0: The participatory, conversational, social & decentralized web (2007-present)

- The new web empowers people to **interact**, generate, and share multi-media content across the web, seamlessly.
- The web has moved from a solo activity to a series of participatory activities enabled by new web applications, platforms, technologies and methodologies.
- Website have become **2-way platforms** and facilitators of people, content and conversations.
- In addition, these content platforms are **accessible from multiple devices**- the PC, mobile phones, netbooks, and gaming consoles.

A Review of Recent History cont.

Web 3.0: Decentralized, open to everyone, and built on top of blockchain technologies

- The main distinctions between Web 2.0 and Web 3.0 involve data storage, connectivity, currency, and decentralization.
- Web 2.0 is about creating content and interacting with websites.
- Web 3.0 means immersing yourself in the digital experience, and it involves concepts like individual control of personal data, cryptocurrency, and decentralized record keeping on the blockchain.
- Web 3.0 relies on cryptocurrencies and a decentralized finance (DeFi) model. This is part of the **decentralization objective**, which shifts control from centralized companies or governments to users or the collective.
- The premise of decentralization extends beyond currency, covering everything from apps to data.



Popular Athletes on Social Media



Endorsements	Average
\$37m	12.6m
Search Score	Average
100	35
Social Following	Average
148m	10.6

World Fame 100 (ESPN, 2019)

How do you know you're famous? When everyone is talking about you, or in this day and age, looking you up on Google. For our fourth annual World Fame 100, we bring you each athlete's most searched moment worldwide, as measured by Google Trends. To identify the 100 most famous athletes in the world, we started with 800 of the biggest names in sports, drawn from 78 countries. We then ranked them based on a formula that took into account three fame factors:

- Search score
- Endorsement dollars
- Social media followers

http://www.espn.com/espn/feature/story/_/id/26113613/espn-world-fame-100-2019

Authentic... is a key



Nike Basketball 
@nikebasketball



[@sparkofkindness](#) I'm seriously thinking about starting my own. I enjoy this connection with no filters

 Reply  Retweet  Favorite

152
RETWEETS

122
FAVORITES



7:38 PM - 27 Dec 12 · Embed this Tweet

Kobe Bryant took over the @NikeBasketball account for a day in December 2012 and alluded to using Twitter on his own.

<https://twitter.com/kobebryant/status/287245259572903937>

Authentic... is a key cont.



Kobe Bryant ✓
@kobebryant

Follow

The antisocial has become social
[#mambatweets](#)

 Reply  Retweet  Favorite  More

51,451
RETWEETS

16,633
FAVORITES



9:13 AM - 4 Jan 13

<https://twitter.com/kobebryant/status/287245259572903937>

Authentic... is a key cont.

New Hampshire
Haverhill
Boston and Beyond
World/Nation
Business
Sports ▼
Video
ET TV
Taste of the Trib
Lifestyle
Opinion
Obituaries
Celebrations
Community Listings
Blogs
Hot Deals
Find a Business
Find a Home
Real Estate

Shaq turns into statue at Harvard Sq.

CAMBRIDGE (AP) — It started with a simple tweet.

Boston Celtics big man Shaquille O'Neal sent a tweet to followers yesterday afternoon that he was headed to Harvard Square to pose silently for photographs.

He had promised the stunt two weeks ago on Boston sports radio station 98.5 FM without specifying a time.

For more than an hour, the 38-year-old NBA veteran posed as a statue while dozens of curious onlookers took pictures of him just off the campus of Harvard University.

Shaq said nothing, but witnesses say he did smile at some fans' comments.

Afterward, Shaq tweeted a "thank you" to those who showed up.

O'Neal and the Celtics open the season Tuesday in Boston against LeBron James and the Miami Heat.



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proactiv. **GET IT NOW**

*Individual results may vary

Related Photos

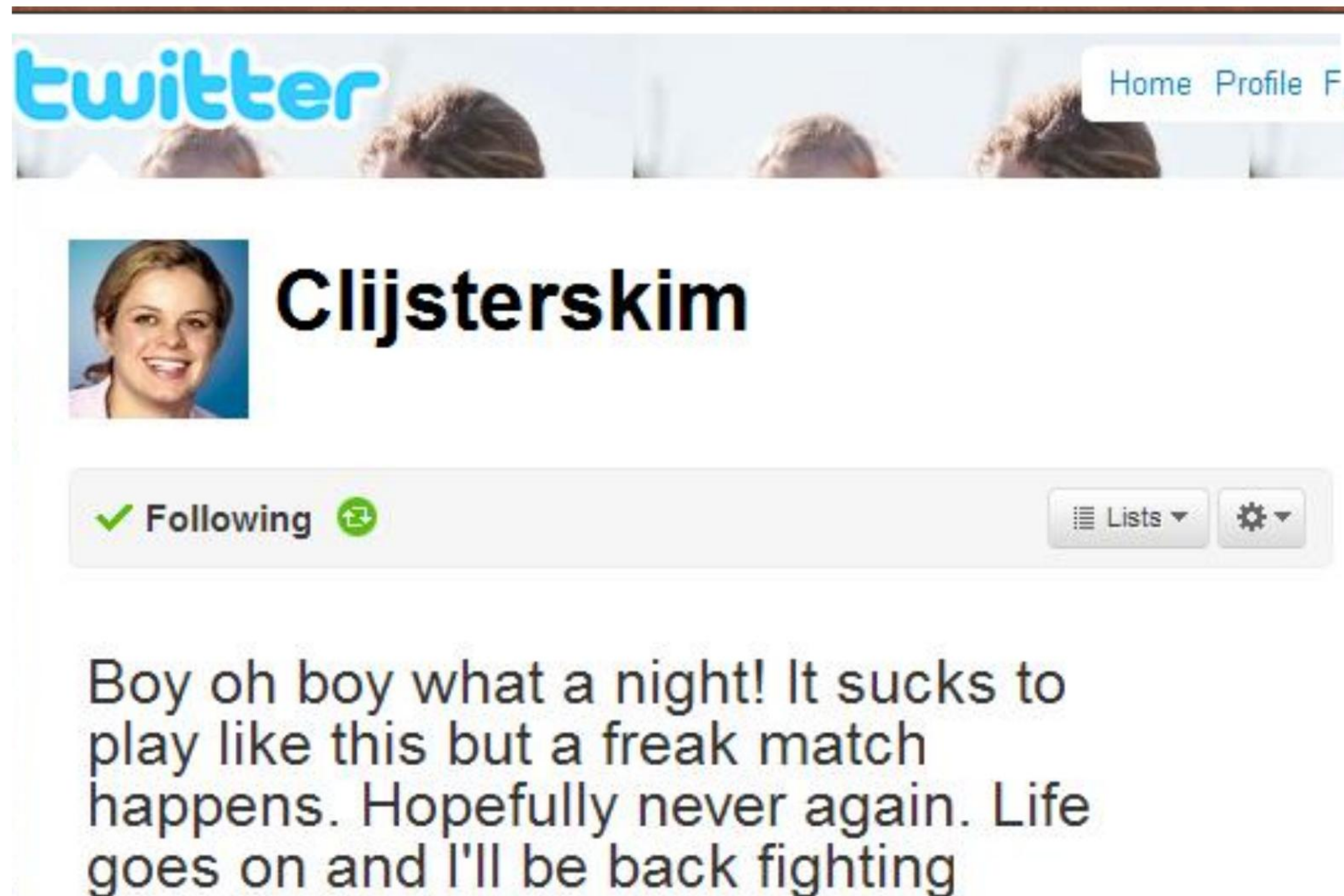


Boston Celtics center Shaquille O'Neal, center, poses as a statue in Harvard Square in Cambridge, Mass., Thursday, Oct. 21, 2010. O'Neal sent a Twitter tweet to followers, then arrived and posed in silence for more than an hour just off the campus of Harvard University. (AP Photo/The Boston Globe, Yoon S. Byun) **

MANDATORY CREDIT. NO INTERNET USE. MAGS OUT. BOSTON OUT.

Transparency

Kim Clijsters about her stunning loss 6-0, 6-1 against Nadia Petrova at 2010 Australian Open.



Transparency cont.

The caption appears to be a not-so-thinly-veiled shot at 2020 Olympic teammate MyKayla Skinner. “Besides Simone, I feel like the talent and the depth just isn’t like what it used to be” and “the girls just don’t have the work ethic.”



Charity Auctions



TwitChange

@TwitChange Worldwide!
We bring celebrities and fans together on Twitter for online charity auctions that CHANGE THE WORLD!
<http://TwitChange.com>

✓ Following



⌵

⚙

Timeline

Favorites

Following

Followers

Lists

**TwitChange** TwitChange
@simonereyes Thank you for joining us!!
8 minutes ago

**simonereyes** Simone Reyes  by TwitChange
I'm there 4 the troops! RT **@TwitChange**: Curious, who did YOU bid on today at <http://TwitChange.com?>
16 minutes ago

**TwitChange** TwitChange
@LASportsGirl Thanks for all your support!
9 minutes ago

**TwitChange** TwitChange
@hollvheartsnick Thanks friend!

 About @TwitChange

4,421

22,312

27,467

606

Tweets

Following

Followers

Listed

Connections

Followed by **@THE_REAL_SHAQ**.



You both follow **@steelers**, **@THE_REAL_SHAQ**



Following 22,312



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FREE
shipping



TWITCHANGE Troy Polamalu MEGA @tpolamalu 🎟️

Proceeds benefit Operation Once in a Lifetime

Item condition: --

Time left: 4d 03h (Feb 03, 2011 09:00:31 PST)

Bid history: [58 bids](#)

Current bid: **US \$7,100.00**

Your max bid:

US \$

(Enter US \$7,200.00 or more)

[Place bid](#)

[Add to Watch list](#)

Shipping: **FREE** Standard Shipping | [See all details](#)

Delivery: Estimated between **Mon. Feb. 28** and **Fri. Mar. 4** ?

Returns: 7 day money back, buyer pays return shipping | [Read details](#)

Zoom unavailable

[Enlarge](#)

Athletes for Purpose



At the beginning of 2023, Instagram partnered with three of the UK's most exciting athletes. The goal? To shine a light on the causes that mattered the most to them. Together with **Jack Grealish**, **Emma Raducanu** and **George Russell** we co-produced Reels content throughout the year, giving them a platform to amplify the causes that they hold close to their hearts and share their own personal experiences. Their chosen advocacies? For Jack it was child disability, for George it was exploring the topic of mental health awareness and for Emma it was the importance of young children staying active in sports

Fulfillment of Fans' curiosity

Steven Jackson



2004-2012



2013-2014



2015

Steven Jackson

He decided to commission a documentary to give the fans a clearer sense of what players go through.

<http://www.sj39.com/film-video/>



“With the media and the Internet, we don’t have to allow for other media outlets to outline who we are as a person as an athlete”

<http://online.wsj.com/video/the-hardest-working-running-back/ED16AF7B-FC1B-43BF-B294-B7AE800010D8.html>

Justin Thomas

PGA TOUR Originals: JT Unlocked presented by WHOOP offers unique insight from 14-time PGA TOUR champion Justin Thomas about his preparation to become his best possible self on and off the golf course, along with access to his life at home as he relaxes and unwinds from the various demands of life on TOUR.

Watch Video Clip (below)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=s6J2yWxW9sM&t=1078s>



Social media is ...

TRANSPARANT

INCLUSIVE

AUTHENTIC

VIBRANT

PEOPLE-DRIVEN

And not...

VEILED

EXCLUSIVE

CONTRIVED

MONOTONE

BRAND-DRIVEN

Social media attack dooms Cutler

Did Cutler quit?

(2011 NFC championship)

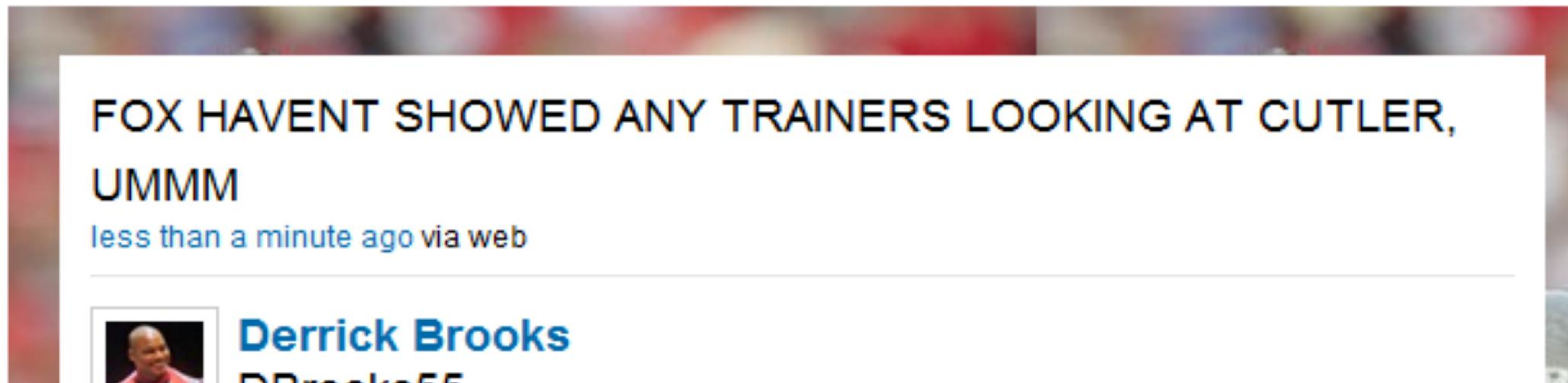
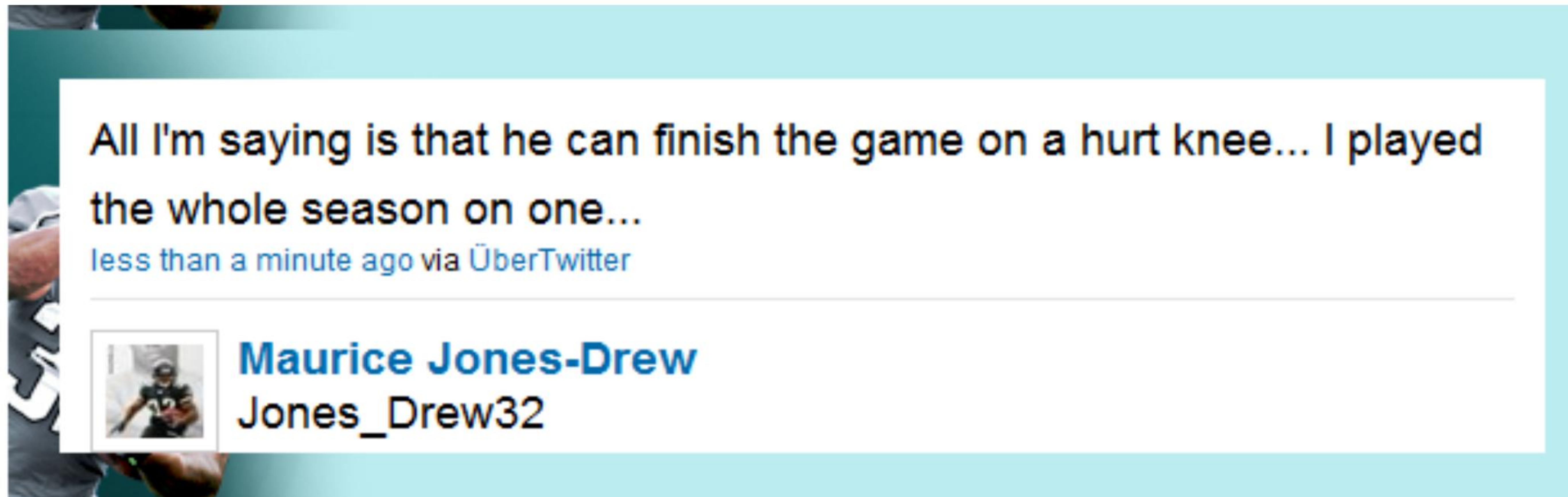


http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J2_NHfEuDZw

Watch video clip

Social media attack dooms cutler cont.

The NFL's first player-on-player social media attack



Social media attack dooms cutler cont.

The NFL's first player-on-player social media attack

Knee-gate in Chicago

less than a minute ago via Plume



Anthony Armstrong

MrArmstrong13

Its hard to know, but it def looked like it. RT @LSUFAN869:

@LanceMoore16 Cutler gave up wouldn't you say?

less than a minute ago via ÜberTwitter



Lance Moore

LanceMoore16

If I'm on chicago team jay cutler has to wait till me and the team
shower get dressed and leave before he comes in the locker room!

#FACT

less than a minute ago via ÜberTwitter



DARNELL DOCKETT

ddockett



Player vs Fan

Russell Westbrook Says Utah Jazz Fan Made 'Racial' Taunt That Led to Confrontation

Player vs Fan cont.

The confrontation between Westbrook and the Jazz fan

Watch video below:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FCmjUyZBmcw>



Replying to @E_Woodyard

Russell Westbrook says the fan and his wife told him to "to get down on your knees like you're used to" which is why he responded. "As for beating up his wife, I've never put my hand on a woman. I never will. Never been in any domestic violence before and never have," he said.



https://twitter.com/E_Woodyard/status/1105326957191815168

Player vs Fan cont.

Jazz owner Gail Miller addresses crowd following Russell Westbrook incident

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IWEUqog3F60>

-The Fan named Shane Keisel was permanently banned from Utah Jazz in 2019

-The NBA announced that it had fined Westbrook \$25,000 “for directing profanity and threatening language to a fan.”



<https://www.nytimes.com/2019/03/12/sports/russell-westbrook-utah-fan.html>

Fans are able to **'scrap and share'** exclusive content with their social networks contributing to the team, league and athlete's **'accumulated influence'** beyond traditional media platforms.

**“Twitter is a waste of time”, says
Manchester United manager Sir
Alex Ferguson**

